

Harkaran Singh Boparai is the Founder and Principal Architect, Harkaran Boparai Studio (HBS), a multidisciplinary design studio, dedicated to the highest level of detail and creative expression
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Photograph by AVESH GAUR

light, moderated sound, measured proportions, and an intuitive understanding of airflow and movement. Together, they create an atmosphere that feels grounded and composed.

Power of Spatial Homogeneity

This quality is not accidental. It comes from what might be described as a sweet homogeneity—a condition where form, material, light, and spatial rhythm align so seamlessly that no single element dominates. The experience is not overtly designed to impress; instead, it supports stillness. One does not need to analyse these spaces to feel their effect. The body responds instinctively, registering comfort and orientation before the mind begins to interpret meaning.

Translating Sanctuary to Daily Life

If architecture can generate this sense of ease in consecrated environments, it raises an important consideration for contemporary practice. Why should these principles be limited to spaces of worship? Today, people spend the majority of their waking hours not in temples or sanctuaries, but in offices and homes. These are the spaces that shape daily routines, stress levels, and long-term well-being. Yet they are often designed around efficiency, scale, or visual impact, with less attention given to how they are felt over time.

Balancing Scale and Restraint

The challenge becomes even more pronounced in large residential projects, where scale can easily lead to excess. For instance, in one of our ongoing residential projects in